Lesson plan · for the teacher

When data goes wrong: handling an incident

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 4

Time	Materials
40 min	Board and chalk; Three handwritten incident cards per group; A sheet of paper for an incident log (optional)

Learning goals

- Recognise a data incident.
- Follow the five steps: contain, report, assess, notify, learn.
- Report early, and help others report without fear.

Activity: Incident cards

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the burst-pipe story: water floods a classroom. Ask pupils what they would do first, and who they would tell.
2. Teach (8 min): Write the five steps on the board: contain, report, assess, notify, learn. Link each one to the burst pipe.
3. Incident cards (15 min): Each group gets a card: a lost phone, a photo sent to the wrong group, a hacked game account. They decide the first thing to do, who to tell, and what would stop it happening again.
4. Share (7 min): Each group acts out its first two minutes. The class checks: did they contain it, and did they tell someone?
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one incident and the first thing they would do. Praise anyone who chose to tell an adult quickly.

Before the lesson, write one set of incident cards per group: “Your phone is lost on the bus”, “You sent a class photo to the wrong group”, “Your game account is sending strange messages to your friends”.

Discussion

- Why does telling quickly keep the damage small?
- Who would you tell at our school?
- What could stop this happening again?

Exit ticket

- One incident + the first thing I would do.

Try it at school tomorrow

Give each group a card: a lost phone, a photo sent to the wrong group, a hacked game account. Each group decides the first thing to do, who to tell, and what would stop it happening again, then shares with the class.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **Your email has started sending scam messages to parents. Which step comes first?**

- ◯ Notify: email parents a long explanation from the same account
- ◯ Learn: write down what went wrong
- ◯ Contain: change the password and sign out of every device

2 **Put the five steps in order.**

- ☐ Notify the people affected
- ☐ Learn: change one thing so it doesn't happen again
- ☐ Report it to the head teacher the same day
- ☐ Contain: stop the damage spreading
- ☐ Assess what data it was, and whose

3 **Which of these are data incidents?**

- ☐ The school printer runs out of ink
- ☐ A teacher's phone with pupils' numbers is stolen
- ☐ A USB stick with exam papers left in a cyber café
- ☐ A parent asks to see their own child's record
- ☐ Marks are sent to the wrong group

4 **If you send data to the wrong group by mistake, it's best to delete it quietly and say nothing, so you don't get into trouble.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **Match each incident to its first containing action.**

Marks sent to the wrong group	• • • •	Change the password; sign out everywhere
A lost phone	• • • •	Delete for everyone; ask parents to delete it
An email sending scams	• • • •	Unplug it from the network
A ransom note on the office computer	• • • •	Lock or erase it from another device

✎ **Think of an incident you've seen or heard of at a school: a lost phone, a message to the wrong group. Which of the five steps was missed, or done late?**

Check your answers

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1 **Contain: change the password and sign out of every device**

Stop the scams first: while the attacker is still in your account, they keep sending.

2 **Top to bottom: 4, 5, 2, 1, 3**

Contain first, because damage grows by the minute; report the same day so the school can act; assess before notifying, so people hear what actually happened; and learn last, when things are calm.

3 **A USB stick with exam papers left in a cyber café; A teacher's phone with pupils' numbers is stolen; Marks are sent to the wrong group**

In the first three, personal data was lost or seen by the wrong people.

4 **False**

Copies may already be saved or forwarded, and the families affected can't protect themselves if nobody tells them.

5 **Marks sent to the wrong group — Delete for everyone; ask parents to delete it**
A lost phone — Lock or erase it from another device
An email sending scams — Change the password; sign out everywhere
A ransom note on the office computer — Unplug it from the network

Each action stops the damage spreading. Reporting comes straight after, the same day.